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Medical device and methods of use

Abstract

The present disclosure is directed to a medical device. Systems and methods are provided for utilizing a laser to break a kidney stones into smaller fragments and/or dust, and removing particles, stone fragments and/or stone dust from a patient. The medical device may include a tube having a distal end and a proximal end, a first lumen extending from the proximal end to the distal end of the tube and in fluid communication with the distal end and a plurality of side ports located at a distal portion of the tube, and a second lumen extending from the proximal end to the distal end of the tube.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. Nonprovisional patent application Ser. No. 15/421,044, filed on Jan. 31, 2017, which claims the benefit of priority of U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/290,219, filed Feb. 2, 2016, the entireties of which are incorporated by reference into this application.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present disclosure relates generally to medical devices. More particularly, the disclosure relates to medical devices used, for example, in breaking objects into smaller particles, and removing the resulting particles from a patient. The disclosure also relates to methods of using such devices.

BACKGROUND OF THE DISCLOSURE

(2) The incidence of hospitalization for the removal of urinary calculi, commonly referred to as kidney stones, has been estimated at 200,000 cases per year. A vast majority of these patients pass their stones spontaneously; however, in the remainder, the kidney stone(s) become impacted in the ureter, a muscle tube joining the kidney to the bladder. An impacted kidney stone is a source of intense pain and bleeding, a source of infection and, if a stone completely blocks the flow of urine for any extended length of time, can cause the loss of a kidney.

(3) Various methods have been utilized to break the stone into smaller fragments. One such method is stone dusting. Stone dusting is used by some urologists to fragment and evacuate stones from a kidney and is often performed by a ureteroscope. Intense light energy from a laser within the ureteroscope breaks the stone into increasingly smaller pieces. Rather than breaking up the stone into chunks, which are removed by baskets, dusting generates very small fragments that are capable of being passed naturally. However, in some cases, these small stone fragments may not pass naturally. In theory, any of these small stone fragments that do not evacuate through natural urine flow, could be a seed for new stone growth. Thus, the application of suction may be employed to remove the stone dust. A pressure equilibrium should be maintained within the kidney and in order to apply suction, fluid should also be introduced. The disclosure addresses the above-mentioned process and other problems in the art.

SUMMARY OF THE DISCLOSURE

(4) Aspects of the present disclosure provide devices and methods for breaking an object into

smaller particles and removing said particles from portions of the human body.

(5) It is to be understood that both the foregoing general description and the following detailed description are exemplary and explanatory only and are not restrictive.

(6) In one example, a medical device may include a tube having a distal end and a proximal end, a first lumen extending from the proximal end to the distal end of the tube and in fluid communication with the distal end and a plurality of side ports located at a distal portion of the tube, and a second lumen extending from the proximal end to the distal end of the tube.

(7) Examples of the medical device may additionally and/or alternatively include one or more other features. Features of the various examples described in the following may be combined unless explicitly stated to the contrary. For example, the tube may be in fluid communication with a cap located at the distal portion, and the cap may be removably attached to the tube. The medical device may include a laser fiber disposed within the first lumen. The plurality of side ports may be disposed on a circumference of the distal portion. The plurality of ports may be disposed on less than 270 degrees of the circumference of the distal portion. The medical device may include a vacuum source connected to the second lumen and a fluid supply assembly connected to the first lumen. The medical device may include an illumination device and an imaging device. The plurality of side ports may include a plurality of linear rows. The plurality of side ports may include at least three ports. The medical device may include a laser fiber holder. The laser fiber holder may be at least partially disposed the first lumen.

(8) In another example, a method operating a medical device may include positioning a distal end of a medical device at a target area, the medical device including a first lumen and a second lumen, wherein the first lumen is in fluid communication with a distal end of the medical device and with side ports on a distal portion of the medical device, supplying fluid through the first lumen, and applying suction through the second lumen.

(9) Examples of the method of operating the medical device may additionally and/or alternatively include one or more other features. For example, a laser fiber holder may be at least partially disposed within the first lumen. The method may include inserting a laser fiber in the first lumen and extending the laser fiber to the distal end of the medical device, and initiating the laser.

(10) In one example, a laser fiber holder may include a first proximal hole and a second distal hole opposite the first, configured to stabilize a laser fiber extending through the first hole and the second hole.

(11) Examples of the laser fiber holder may additionally and/or alternatively include one or more other features. Features of the various examples described in the following may be combined unless explicitly stated to the contrary. For example, the laser fiber holder may be sized to be secured within a lumen. The laser fiber holder may have an inverted configuration and an extended configuration. The laser fiber holder may include at least one ramp. The laser fiber holder may include at least one helix. The laser fiber holder may be configured to allow fluid to flow through the laser fiber holder.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The accompanying drawings, which are incorporated in and constitute a part of this specification, illustrate various examples and together with the description, serve to explain the principles of the disclosure.

(2) FIG. 1 illustrates an exemplary medical device, including a tube, a distal portion, a handle portion, a fluid supply assembly, a laser source, an illumination source, an imaging apparatus, and a vacuum source;

(3) FIG. 2 illustrates an exemplary cross-section of the tube taken at 2-2 of FIG. 1;

- (4) FIGS. 3A and 3B illustrate an exemplary perspective view and an exemplary side view of a distal end of the medical device of FIG. 1;
- (5) FIG. 4 illustrates an exemplary medical device extending into a patient's body; and
- (6) FIGS. 5A and 5B illustrate an exemplary perspective view and an exemplary side view of an alternative distal end of the medical device of FIG. 1;
- (7) FIG. 6 illustrates an exemplary laser fiber holder;
- (8) FIGS. 7A and 7B illustrate an exemplary perspective view and exemplary cross-section of an alternative exemplary laser fiber holder;
- (9) FIGS. 8A and 8B illustrate an exemplary perspective view and exemplary cross-section of an alternative exemplary laser fiber holder;
- (10) FIGS. 9A and 9B illustrate an exemplary perspective view and exemplary cross-section of an alternative exemplary laser fiber holder;
- (11) FIGS. 10A and 10B illustrate an exemplary perspective view and exemplary cross-section of an alternative exemplary laser fiber holder;
- (12) FIG. 11 illustrates an exemplary side view of an alternative exemplary laser fiber holder;
- (13) FIG. 12 illustrates an exemplary side view of an alternative exemplary laser fiber holder and a laser fiber;
- (14) FIG. 13 illustrates an exemplary side view of an alternative exemplary laser fiber holder and a laser fiber; and
- (15) FIG. 14 illustrates an exemplary side view of an alternative exemplary laser fiber holder and a laser fiber.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(16) Reference is now made in detail to examples of the present disclosure, examples of which are illustrated in the accompanying drawings. Wherever possible, the same reference numbers will be used throughout the drawings to refer to the same or like parts. The term “distal” refers to a position farther away from a user end of the device. The term “proximal” refers a position closer to the user end of the device. As used herein, the terms “approximately” and “substantially” indicate a range of values within $\pm 5\%$ of a stated value.

OVERVIEW

(17) Aspects of the present disclosure relate to systems and methods for breaking kidney stones into smaller particles and removing those particles from the body. The medical devices described herein may work by positioning within a body, a ureteroscope and a laser disposed within a lumen of the ureteroscope. The laser may be used to break up kidney stones into particles. During the laser process or after removal of the laser from the body and/or lumen, the ureteroscope may vacuum the resulting particles from the body. More specifically, in some examples, the ureteroscope includes a tube with at least two lumens. A first lumen may be a working channel configured to receive and position a laser and provide fluid to irrigate a target area. A second lumen may provide suction to carry out the irrigation fluid along with the particles. In some examples, the tube may connect to a distal portion or a cap. The first lumen of the tube may connect to a corresponding first lumen in the cap. The first lumen of the cap may connect to both a substantially distal-facing opening at a distal end of the cap, as well as, a plurality of ports around the circumference of the cap. In some examples, the medical device may not include a cap and the tube will be designed with a distal-facing opening and a plurality of ports around a circumference of the tube in fluid communication with the first lumen.

(18) The target area may be any location. In some examples, the target area may be anywhere within a urinary tract including, but not limited to, a kidney. In some examples, the target area may be a site in the body where a kidney stone(s) is known or suspected to be located.

(19) Aspects of the present disclosure may additionally or alternatively relate to systems and methods for securing a laser fiber within a lumen of a medical device. For example, a laser fiber may be secured within a working channel of a ureteroscope to ensure that flow within the body,

including introduced irrigation fluid, kidney stones and particles, and/or the application of suction do not unintentionally move the laser fiber. Such a laser fiber holder may also ensure that as the distal end of the ureteroscope moves (including any associated imaging devices), the laser fiber matches these movements. The laser fiber holders described herein are not limited to the medical devices and lumens described herein, but may be used with any medical device and/or any lumen to secure, stabilize, and/or control the movements of a laser fiber.

DETAILED EXAMPLES

(20) FIG. 1 illustrates an exemplary medical device **100** for breaking an object into fragments and removing the resulting fragments from the target area, e.g., the kidney. The device **100** may include a tube **102** and/or a distal portion **115**. Tube **102** may be a hollow, flexible, elongate tube having a proximal end **106** and a distal end **104**. Distal end **104** of tube **102** may either include an integral distal portion **115** or distal end **104** of tube **102** may be coupled to a separate and distinct distal portion **115**. Distal portion **115** and/or tube **102** may further include independent first and second lumens **112** and **114** (FIG. 2). Proximal end **106** of tube **102** may be coupled to a handle portion **110**. The handle portion **110** and/or the proximal end **106** of tube **102** may be attached to a laser control **130**, a fluid supply assembly **140**, a vacuum source **150**, an illumination source **160**, and/or an imaging apparatus **170**.

(21) A. The Tube

(22) As noted above, tube **102** may include two independent lumens, first lumen **112** and second lumen **114**. While two lumens are illustrated in FIG. 4, tube **102** may include any number of lumens. For example, as shown in FIG. 2, tube **102** may include three lumens; a first lumen **112** for introduction of fluid and a laser fiber, a second lumen **114** for the application of suction, and a third lumen **116** for wires/fibers/etc. necessary for controlling and communication with an imaging and/or illumination device(s) located at a distal end of the medical device **100**. In some examples, a fourth and/or fifth lumen may be included for, e.g., a separate lumen exclusively for the introduction of the laser fiber or an additional lumen for the introduction of fluid through the side ports. The lumens included in tube **102** may be any size, shape, and/or in any configuration. An exemplary cross-section of tube **102**, including first lumen **112**, second lumen **114**, and third lumen **116** will be described in further detail below with respect to FIG. 2.

(23) Tube **102** and/or distal portion **115** may be circular, ovoidal, irregular, and/or any shape suitable to enter a body. Further, tube **102** may have the same shape or a different shape than distal portion **115**. For example, both tube **102** and distal portion **115** may be substantially circular. Tube **102** may have a uniform shape from proximal end **106** to distal end **104** and/or from proximal end **106** to distal end **105** of distal portion **115**. In some examples, tube **102** (and/or distal portion **115**) may have a varying shape, such as a taper at the distal end to facilitate insertion within the body.

(24) Depending upon the particular implementation and intended use, the length of tube **102** may vary. Similarly, depending upon the particular implementation and intended use, tube **102** can be rigid along its entire length, flexible along a portion of its length, or configured for flexure at only certain specified locations. In one example, tube **102** may be flexible, adapted for flexible steering within bodily lumens, as understood in the art. For example, tube **102** can include a steering system (not shown) to move at least a portion (e.g., distal end **104**) up/down and/or side-to-side. Additional degrees of freedom, provided for example via rotation, translational movement of tube **102**, or additional articulation of bending sections, may also be implemented. Examples of such steering systems may include at least one of pulleys, control wires, gearing, or electrical actuators.

(25) Tube **102** and/or distal portion **115** may be formed of any suitable material having sufficient flexibility to traverse body cavities and tracts. In general, tube **102** and/or distal portion **115** may be made of any suitable material that is compatible with living tissue or a living system. That is, the tube **102** and/or distal portion **115** may be non-toxic or non-injurious, and it should not cause immunological reaction or rejection. In some examples, tube **102** and/or distal portion **115** may be made of polymeric elastomers, rubber tubing, and/or medically approved polyvinylchloride tubing.

Polymeric elastomers may be, for example, EVA (Ethylene vinyl acetate), silicone, polyurethane, and/or C-Flex. Tube **102** and/or distal portion **115** may be made of the same or different material. (26) FIG. 2 illustrates a cross-sectional view of tube **102** depicting first lumen **112**, second lumen **114**, and third lumen **116**. This view may, for example, be at line 2-2 of FIG. 1, proximal end **106** of tube **102**, distal end **104** of tube **102**, and/or at the proximal end of distal portion **115** (as described in more detail below). As shown, first lumen **112** and second lumen **114** may be an arc- or curved-shaped lumen and third lumen **116** may be substantially circular in shape and disposed within a wall within tube **102** between first lumen **112** and second lumen **114**. The size and shape of first lumen **112**, second lumen **114**, and/or third lumen **116** are not limited thereto. For example, first lumen **112** and second lumen **114** may be substantially semi-circular in shape and either the wall between the two may be larger to accommodate third lumen **116** without effecting the shape of lumens **112** and **114** or third lumen **116** may have a smaller cross-sectional area than shown in FIG. 2. In some examples, lumens **112** and **114** have approximately the same cross-sectional shape and size. In some examples lumen **112** and **114** have a different shape and/or size. Any of lumens **112**, **114**, and/or **116** may be configured to supply fluid, apply suction, and/or transport visualization devices or laser fibers. Lumen **116** may have a diameter of approximately 2×0.5 mm to approximately 3.5×1.5 mm, approximately 2.4×0.8 mm to approximately 3.2×1.6 mm, or approximately 2.6×1 mm to approximately 3×1.4 mm. Lumen **114** and **112** may have a surface area of approximately 1.2-2.2 mm.^{sup.2}, approximately 1.4-2 mm.^{sup.2}, or approximately 1.6-1.8 mm.^{sup.2}. In some examples, lumen **114** and **112** are chamfered surfaces.

(27) First lumen **112**, second lumen **114**, and/or third lumen **116** may include any suitable coating. For example, first lumen **112**, second lumen **114**, and/or third lumen **116** may include a layer of lubricous material, for example, to facilitate insertion of any instrument and/or device (e.g., laser fiber **120** through first lumen **112**) or prevent clogging (e.g., as a result of stone fragments/dust in second lumen **114**). First lumen **112**, second lumen **114**, and/or third lumen **116** may be defined by elongate hollow lumens that extend within tube **102**.

(28) First lumen **112**, second lumen **114**, and/or third lumen **116** may extend between proximal end **106** and distal **104**. First lumen **112** may be open (e.g., open to a body cavity like a kidney) at the distal end **104** of tube **102** to allow introduction of a laser fiber **120** and/or flow of irrigation fluid. In examples in which a cap (e.g., distal portion **115**) is attached to distal end **104** of tube **102**, first lumen **112** may align with an opening within distal portion **115** to extend the first lumen **112** through to the distal end **105** of the distal portion **115** and/or side ports **122** to allow the flow of irrigation fluid within first lumen **112** to exit into the kidney at a plurality of locations along an exterior circumference of distal portion **115**. The distal opening of first lumen **112** (e.g., at distal end **105** of distal portion **115**) may be substantially perpendicular to the tube (e.g., as shown in FIGS. 5A and 5B), may be tapered or angled (e.g., as shown in FIGS. 3A and 3B), or may be in any other suitable shape, size, and/or orientation. Within distal portion **115** (e.g., between distal end **105** of distal portion **115** and distal end **104** of tube **102**), first lumen **112** may fork and/or include a plurality of small branches at multiple locations to place first lumen **112** in fluid communication with a plurality of ports **122**. The proximal end of first lumen **112** may have any shape or configuration. For example, first lumen **112** may have two openings or may fork at or near the proximal end **106** of tube **102**. First lumen **112** may be configured in any way that would allow for first lumen **112** to be simultaneously connected to fluid supply apparatus **140** and laser control **130**. This may allow laser fiber **120** to be disposed within first lumen **112** at the same time fluid is introduced through first lumen **112** to side ports **122** and/or distal end **105**.

(29) Second lumen **114** may be open (e.g., open to a body cavity like a kidney) at the distal end **105** of distal portion **115** of tube **102** to provide for the application of suction. In examples in which a cap (e.g., distal portion **115**) is attached to distal end **104** of tube **102**, second lumen **114** may align with an opening within distal portion **115** to extend the second lumen **114** through to the distal end **105** of the distal portion **115**. The distal opening of second lumen **114** (e.g., at distal end **105** of

distal portion **115**) may be substantially perpendicular to the tube (e.g., as shown in FIGS. 5A and 5B), may be tapered or angled (e.g., as shown in FIGS. 3A and 3B), or may be in any other suitable shape, size, and/or orientation. Second lumen **114** may be in fluid communication with vacuum source **150**.

(30) As shown in FIGS. 3A and 3B, distal portion **115** may include a plurality of side ports **122**. In some examples, ports **122** may be substantially or at least partially facing radially outward (e.g., approximately perpendicular to the longitudinal axis of tube **102**) or ports **122** may be angled toward distal end **105** of distal portion **115** so that the irrigation fluid is introduced toward the distal end of the medical device. The angling of fluid introduced through ports **122** may also include angling the passage(s) (e.g., branches extending from first lumen **112**) connected to ports **122**. The angle of the introduction of fluid may be greater than approximately 10 degrees from longitudinal axis of first lumen **112** to less than approximately 90 degrees from the longitudinal axis of first lumen **112**, preferably between approximately 20 degrees and approximately 80 degrees. In some examples, the preferred angle of introduction of fluid may be between approximately 30 degrees and approximately 60 degrees. Angling the introduction of fluid toward the distal end **105** of distal portion **115** may assist in pushing stone fragments/dust toward the vacuum, e.g., distal opening of second lumen **114**.

(31) There may be any number of side ports **122**, spaced any distance apart, and located anywhere along the radial surface of distal portion **115**. In some examples, distal portion **115** includes at least three side ports. The plurality of ports may include any numbers of rows. In the examples illustrated herein, the rows are substantially linear, but the plurality of ports is not limited thereto and may be in any pattern. In some examples, each row includes at least three ports. In the example shown in FIG. 3A, each row includes four ports. In the example illustrated in FIG. 1, a first row includes five ports and a second row includes four ports. Each row, however, may include any number of ports. The ports may be disposed on any portion of the circumference. For example, the ports may be located on an entire 360 degrees of the circumference of distal portion **115**. In other examples, like those illustrated in FIGS. 3A and 5A, ports **122** may be disposed on less than between approximately 300 degrees and approximately 200 degrees and greater than approximately 45 degrees or approximately 90 degrees, or disposed on approximately 180 degrees of the circumference of distal portion **115**. Ports **122** may only be on a portion (e.g., less than 360 degrees) of the outer surface, so that ports **122** are adjacent to first lumen **112** (e.g., the lumen in fluid communication with fluid supply assembly **140**). Otherwise, in examples in which ports **122** are disposed on 360 degrees of the outer surface, additional space may be required within tube **102** and/or distal portion **115** to provide access to first lumen **112** to ports that are adjacent to second lumen **114**. For example, connecting lumens (e.g., to connect additional ports to fluid supply assembly **140**) may be disposed radially outwardly of second lumen **114** and thus increase the outer diameter of distal portion **115** and/or decrease the internal diameter of lumens within distal portion **115**. By positioning side ports **122** on the sides of tube **102**, more surface area will be available on the distal face of tube **102** (e.g., by minimizing the volume of fluid through the distal end of first lumen **112** and thus cross-sectional area of first lumen **112** at the distal end). Thus, the cross-sectional area of distal opening of second lumen **114** may be maximized while providing sufficient inlet flow of irrigation fluid to provide a clear view for any imaging devices.

(32) The side ports **122** may be any size and/or shape. For example, ports **122** may be substantially circular and may have a diameter of approximately 0.2 mm to approximately 0.8 mm, approximately 0.3 mm to approximately 0.6 mm, or approximately 0.3 mm to approximately 0.5 mm. In some examples, each of the plurality of ports **122** may have substantially the same diameter. In some examples, the diameter of each of port **122** may vary. In some examples, ports **122** may be located within substantially circular recesses. These recesses may prevent abrasion of a patient's tissue during insertion or removal of medical device **100** to and from the patient's body. The diameter of these recesses may be approximately 1.5 to approximately 3 times the diameter of

its corresponding port **122**, or approximately 2 times the diameter of its corresponding port. Ports **122** may be in any pattern. As shown in FIG. 3A, ports **122** may be in uniform rows. In some examples, the density of ports **122** may vary, e.g., ports may be closer together at the distal end than the proximal or vice versa. In some examples, the ports may be concentrated on the surface opposite the lumen used for suction (e.g., second lumen **114**) or vice versa.

(33) Distal end **105** of distal portion **115** of tube **102** may include visualization devices such as imaging and/or illumination device **124**. These device(s) may be connected to imaging apparatus **170** and illumination source **160**, respectively. As shown below in FIG. 3A, imaging and/or illumination device **124** may be disposed on a distal facing surface of distal portion **115**. These devices and/or connecting wires may extend within the tube **102** (e.g., third lumen **116** of FIG. 2). For example, an imaging device may be a digital camera and signal and/or power lines may extend through third lumen **116**. The illumination device may be an LED and a fiber may extend through lumen **116**. Imaging and/or illumination device **124** may attach to the distal end **105** using known coupling mechanisms. Imaging and/or illumination device **124** may be any imaging device and/or illumination device known in the art. As shown in FIG. 3A, the imaging device and illumination device may have a substantially circular cross-section and/or may be integrated into a single unit. Additionally or alternatively, the visualization devices may be detachably introduced into tube **102** through other lumens, including first lumen **112** and/or second lumen **114** when required. For example, the proximal end of first lumen **112** and/or second lumen **114** may be forked to allow introduction of additional devices as well as a connection to either fluid supply apparatus **140** and/or vacuum source **150**. Additionally or alternatively, first lumen **112** and/or second lumen **114** may include side port(s) at or near proximal end **106** for introduction of additional devices.

(34) As mentioned above, distal end **104** of tube **102** may be permanently or removably coupled to a distal portion **115** (e.g., a cap). In some examples, the disclosed distal portion, e.g., cap, may be made integrally with distal end **104** of tube **102**. The distal portion **115** may be temporarily or permanently attached to the tube's distal end **104**. Temporary attachments may, for instance, be defined by a screw-fit, Luer taper, snap-fit, or compression fit arrangement. Furthermore, mechanisms for holding the attachment section to the ureteroscope, endoscope, catheter, etc. may be used, including, e.g., hose clamps, crimp bands, wrapped filaments, clips, etc. Permanent attachment may include welding, gluing, soldering, or other forms of attachment, or the desired cap may be integrally formed with tube **102**. It will be appreciated that other forms of temporary or permanent attachment may be adopted without departing from the scope of the present disclosure. In some examples, the desired cap may be integral with a sheath which fits along a portion of the tube or a sheath that extends substantially the entire length of the endoscope.

(35) In examples in which distal portion **115** is separate from tube **102**, a proximal end of distal portion **115** may include a plurality of openings to align with distal openings of the lumens of tube **102**. Depending on tube **102**, the configuration of the plurality of openings may be adjusted. For example, a distal portion **115** designed to connect to tube **102** may include a first opening to align and fluidly connect with a first lumen **112** of FIG. 2. The first opening of the proximal end of distal portion **115** may match the first lumen **112** of FIG. 2, e.g., be substantially arc or curved in shape. Similarly, the proximal end of distal portion **115** may include a second and third opening to align and fluidly connect with second and third lumens **114** and **116**, respectively. In examples in which tube **102** includes two semi-circular shaped lumens, the proximal end of distal portion **115** would similarly include two proximal openings in fluid communication with these lumens. A distal end of distal portion **115** may include any number, shape and/or configuration of distal openings. As shown in FIG. 3A, distal portion **115** may include a first distal opening and a second distal opening in fluid communication with first and second lumens **112** and **114**, respectively. As shown, these distal openings are approximately semi-circular in shape and include angled walls. In addition, distal portion **115** includes a plurality of ports **122**.

(36) B. The Handle Portion

(37) Handle portion **110** can be attached to tube **102** by, for example, welding, a locking configuration, adhesive, or integrally formed with tube **102**. The handle portion **110** may include a plurality of ports. For example, a first port may place first lumen **112** of tube **102** in fluid communication with fluid supply assembly **140** and a second port may place second lumen **114** of tube **102** in fluid communication with vacuum source **150**. Additional ports and lumens may be provided for supplying to distal end **104** of tube **102** a laser fiber coupled to laser control **130**, an illumination device coupled to illumination source **160**, and/or an imaging device coupled to the imaging apparatus **170**. For example, first lumen **112** may include two ports, a first for connecting the fluid supply assembly **140** and a second for connecting laser fiber **120** and/or laser source **130**. The handle portion **110** may include an actuating mechanism (not shown) to actuate one or more medical devices that may be located at the distal end **104** of tube **102**. For example, the handle portion may include an actuating mechanism to power on or off the laser, the illumination device, and/or the imaging device.

(38) The fluid supply assembly **140** may be any device and/or devices that can supply fluid (e.g., saline) to first lumen **112**. The fluid supply assembly **140** may include, but is not limited to, a fluid source, a pump, a control system, a heat exchanger, a filter, a temperature sensor, a pressure sensor, a supply line, and/or various user input devices.

(39) The vacuum source may be any device and/or devices that can provide suction to lumen **114** (e.g., house vacuum, vacuum pump, etc.). The vacuum source **150** may provide suction and allow the operator to vary the suction. The vacuum source **150** may be located near the patient or may be located remotely (such as a vacuum source located on a wall). In some examples, vacuum source **150** may be included in a single unit with fluid supply assembly **140**. For example, fluid supply assembly **140** and vacuum source **150** may be the inlet and outlet, respectively, of a peristaltic pump.

(40) C. Insertion and Operation of the Medical Device

(41) Referring to FIG. **4**, a patient's urinary tract includes urethra **402**, bladder **404**, ureter **406**, and kidney **408**. In some aspects of the present disclosure, the target area, e.g., the area in which particles, like kidney stones **470**, are known or suspected to be located, may be within kidney **408**. Referring to FIG. **4**, an operator (e.g., a doctor or other medical professional) may insert distal end **105** of device **100** into the patient's urethra **402**. The operator may advance distal portion **115** and tube **102** so that distal end **105** of distal portion **115** passes into and through the urinary bladder **404**, into and through ureter **406**, and into kidney **408**. The operator may position a distal opening of first lumen **112** proximate a target area. A target area may be a site where stones (e.g., stone **470**) are known or suspected to be located. An imaging device (e.g., imaging device **124** of FIG. **3A**) may be utilized to determine the location of stone(s), as known in the art. The distal end **105** of distal portion **115** may be adjusted so that first lumen **112** and/or any medical instruments (e.g., laser fiber **120**) disposed within first lumen **112** may be aimed at the located stone(s). Laser fiber **120** may then be introduced through first lumen **112** to distal end **104**. Laser fiber **120** may be connected to and/or controlled by laser control **130**.

(42) As shown in FIG. **4**, once the laser fiber is in a sufficient position to aim for a kidney stone (e.g., stone **470**), the operator may initiate a laser control (e.g., laser control **130**) to break up the kidney stone (e.g., stone **470**).

(43) The operator may connect first lumen **112** to fluid supply assembly **140** and/or may turn on previously connected fluid supply assembly **140** to introduce fluid through first lumen **112** to the target area. The fluid supply assembly **140** may then provide fluid, through first lumen **112**, to the plurality of ports **122** and/or the distal end **105** of distal portion **115** and into kidney **408**. In some examples, the fluid supplied is a saline solution, for example, 0.9% saline. Fluid supply assembly **140** and laser control **130** may be separately or simultaneously connected to first lumen **112**. In addition, first lumen **112** may provide a pathway for other instruments (e.g., basket, grasper, etc.). In some examples, laser **120** and ports **122** may have separate lumens. For example, laser **120** may

extend through first lumen **112** to distal end **105** of distal portion **115** and ports **122** may be in fluid communication with a separate lumen coupled with fluid supply assembly **140**.

(44) Before, after, or simultaneously with the operator turning on the fluid supply assembly **140** to introduce fluid through first lumen **112** to the target area, the operator may turn on the suction (e.g., vacuum source **150**) to pull the stone fragments/dust (e.g., created by breaking stone **470**) into second lumen **114**. The arrows in FIG. **3A** illustrate an exemplary path of irrigation fluid from first lumen **112** and ports **120** to second lumen **114**.

(45) In some examples, the fluid may be provided to first lumen **112** at a variety of flow rates. The fluid may be introduced in a continuous flow or pulsed. In some examples, the flow rate may be pulsed at a regular interval, e.g., every few seconds. The pulsed flow may be a flow that is either intermittently interrupted or simply reduced in rate on an intermittent basis. The flow rate may be pulsed at complex flow rate patterns such as periodic and aperiodic oscillatory patterns. A pulsed flow may be created in any way. In one example, the pulse flow may be created by a mechanical pump, e.g., a peristaltic pump. The mechanical pump may apply and release pressure on the fluid at intervals.

(46) The flow rate of the introduced fluid may be balanced with the flow rate caused by the vacuum source. Balanced flow rates can be substantially equal, but need not be exactly equal. A balanced flow rate may be any flow rate that prevents harm to the patient. For example, a balanced flow rate may be any flow rate of the introduction of fluid in relationship to the flow rate of the suction that prevents hydronephrosis and/or prevents the kidney from collapsing due to no fluid in the system, as known in the art. The balanced flow rate may assist in maintaining a pressure equilibrium during operation of the device. In some examples, a pressure sensor may also be located at or near the target area and/or distal end **104** to assist in maintaining a pressure equilibrium.

(47) In addition, the application of suction may improve the ability to break kidney stones by creating an anti-retropulsion effect. By applying suction through second lumen **114**, a kidney stone may be pulled toward laser fiber **120**, thus countering the effect of the laser energy pushing the kidney stone away. This configuration thus assists in generating the smaller stone fragments by pulling the stones into the reach of laser fiber **120**. Further, by having at least some of the irrigation fluid provided from a side (e.g., ports **122** of distal portion **115**) and suction from distal end **105** of distal portion **115**, the inflow fluid is less likely to interfere with the vacuuming of the stone dust.

(48) Once the operator determines kidney stone **470** has been broken into sufficiently small fragments (e.g., sufficiently small to pass naturally or to be suctioned into second lumen **114**) or does not want to continue for other reasons, the laser process may be stopped. Once the stone fragments/dust have been sufficiently removed from the body through second lumen **114**, the operator may cease introduction of irrigational fluid and/or stop suction. In some examples, the laser process, introduction of irrigational fluid, and/or application suction may all stop at the same time. In other examples, introduction of irrigational fluid and/or suction may continue after the laser process has stopped.

(49) In some examples, fluid supply assembly **140** and/or vacuum source **150** do not operate at the same time as laser fiber **120**. For example, the laser process may cease before introduction of fluid through first lumen **112** and/or application of suction through second lumen **114**. In some examples, laser fiber **120** may be removed from first lumen **112** before fluid is introduced through first lumen **112**.

(50) At any point, an operator may additionally choose to move the device within the patient. For example, an operator may choose to move the distal end **105** of distal portion **115** to the site of an additional kidney stones and/or lower into the kidney or to a location in which additional stone fragments/dust have accumulated. The purpose of repositioning the distal end **105** may be to reach stones or stone fragments that need to be broken into smaller pieces and/or reach stone fragments/dust that the device was previously unable to suction out of the body and into second lumen **114**. For example, some stone fragments/dust may be positioned proximally to the distal

opening or positioned too distally to be captured by applied suction. An operator may reposition distal portion **115**/tube **102** any number of times. Once repositioned, any or all of the previously described steps, e.g., the laser process, introduction of fluid, and/or application of suction, may be repeated at the new location.

(51) Once an operator determines no more kidney stones can and/or should be broken apart and/or no more stone fragments/dust can and/or should be removed, the ureteroscope (e.g., tube **102**) may be removed from the patient's body.

(52) D. Laser Fiber Holder

(53) FIGS. **5A-14** illustrate exemplary laser fiber holders for stabilizing a laser fiber. These laser fiber holders are designed to minimize movement of a laser fiber relative to the lumen or working channel it is disposed within. Stabilizing laser fibers relative to the lumen or working channel of a delivery device may also stabilize the laser fibers relative to an imaging device of the same delivery device. This may increase efficiency and lower the risk of misfiring, damaging healthy tissue as opposed to stones.

(54) The laser fiber holders described herein are not limited to the delivery devices and/or lumens described herein. For example, laser fiber holder **180** of FIGS. **5A**, **5B**, and **6**, laser fiber holder **780** of FIGS. **7A** and **7B**, laser fiber holder **880** of FIGS. **8A** and **8B**, laser fiber holder **980** of FIGS. **9A** and **9B**, laser fiber holder **1080** of FIGS. **10A** and **10B**, laser fiber holder **1180** of FIG. **11**, laser fiber holders **1281** and **1283** of FIG. **12**, laser fiber holder **1381** of FIG. **13**, and/or laser fiber holder **1481** of FIG. **14** may be used in any device/lumen that may receive/deliver a laser e.g., a ureteroscope, an endoscope, catheter, etc. The laser fiber holder may be permanently or removably coupled to the delivery device and/or lumen it is disposed within. In some examples, like those shown above with respect to FIGS. **1-6**, a laser fiber corresponding to a laser fiber holder may be disposed within a lumen that also supplies fluid. In other examples, the laser fiber may have a dedicated working channel that does not supply fluid. In some examples, the laser fiber may be disposed within the lumen applying suction.

(55) The laser fiber holders may be formed of any suitable material having sufficient flexibility to traverse body cavities and tracts. In general, the laser fiber holders may be made of any suitable material that is compatible with living tissue or a living system. That is, laser fiber holders may be non-toxic or non-injurious, and it should not cause immunological reaction or rejection. In some examples, the laser fiber holders may be made of polymeric elastomers, rubber tubing, and/or medically approved polyvinylchloride tubing. Polymeric elastomers may be, for example, EVA (Ethylene vinyl acetate), silicone, polyurethane, and/or C-Flex.

(56) FIGS. **5A** and **5B** illustrate an exemplary perspective view and an exemplary side view of an alternative distal end of the medical device of FIG. **1**. Distal portion **115'** may include any of the features or aspects of distal portion **115**. Distal portion **115'** may include substantially oval first lumen **112** and second lumen **114**. Visualization device **126** may include a substantially rectangular imaging device surrounded by an illumination device (e.g., an LED). Distal portion **115'** may include a laser fiber holder **180**. Laser fiber holder **180** may be disposed within first lumen **112**. In some examples, during insertion of distal portion **115'** into the patient's body, laser fiber holder **180** may be entirely disposed within first lumen **112** in an inverted configuration. Once distal portion **115'** is in position, laser fiber **120** may be inserted through first lumen **112** and pushing laser fiber **120** through opening **184** may transition laser fiber holder **180** from the inverted configuration to the extended configuration shown in FIGS. **5A**, **5B**, and **6**.

(57) FIG. **6** illustrates an exemplary laser fiber holder, for example, laser fiber holder **180** of FIGS. **5A** and **5B**. Laser fiber holder **180** may include four holes. A first proximal hole **181** to connect with the distal opening of first lumen **112**. A second distal hole **184** or laser fiber **120** to extend through and into the patient's body. As shown in FIGS. **5A** and **6**, at least one hole **182** on a radial surface. As shown in FIG. **5A**, irrigation fluid provided through lumen **112** may enter the patient's body through irrigation hole(s) **182**. Laser fiber holder **180** may include any number of irrigation

hole(s) **182**, located on any radial surface. Laser fiber holder **180** may alternatively be used in lumens that apply suction. In these examples, hole(s) **182** may be used to apply suction.

(58) FIGS. 7A and 7B illustrate an exemplary perspective view and exemplary cross-section of an alternative exemplary laser fiber holder **780**. Laser fiber holder **780** is illustrated as hollow and substantially cylindrical, but may be any shape. Laser fiber holder **780** may include holder lumen **781** and/or a bi-direction ramp **752** affixed to a wall of holder lumen **781**. Bi-directional ramp **752** may taper at its proximal and/or distal end. Ramp **752** may be used to direct a tool such as laser fiber **120** within any lumen and/or any delivery device (e.g., first lumen **112** of medical device **100**). Ramp **752** may bias a laser fiber against one side of holder lumen **781**, to stabilize the laser fiber and yet allow fluids to pass as shown in FIG. 7B. In some examples, ramp **752** may be manufactured by stamping. Stamping may create a side port from the wall of holder lumen that is manufactured to form ramp **752**. Laser fiber holder **780** may be embedded into a lumen of a delivery device by the manufacturer or may be inserted into the lumen of the delivery device before the procedure. Laser fiber holder **780** may be secured within the lumen in any way known in the art, including, for example, friction fit. In some examples, laser fiber holder **780** may be inserted into the lumen of the delivery device entirely. In other examples, the laser fiber holder **780** may be inserted partially. For example, at least a portion of ramp **752** (and thus the side port created by the manufacturing of ramp **752**) may be disposed distal of the lumen of the delivery device and thus, fluid within the lumen of the delivery device may flow through the created side port. In some examples, ramp **752** may be spring loaded such that it can collapse and recover its shape.

(59) FIGS. 8A and 8B illustrate an exemplary perspective view and exemplary cross-section of an alternative exemplary laser fiber holder **880** with three bi-directional ramps **852**, **854**, and **856** and thus, three created side ports. Ramps **852**, **854**, and **856** may have any of the features of ramp **752** of FIGS. 7A and 7B. Similarly laser fiber holder **880** may have any of the features of laser fiber holder **780**. Shown in FIG. 8B, a tool such as laser fiber **120** is centered in lumen **881** of laser fiber holder **880** and fluid can flow between the outer diameter of laser fiber **120** and the inner diameter of lumen **881** of laser fiber holder **880**.

(60) FIGS. 9A and 9B illustrate an exemplary perspective view and exemplary cross-section of an alternative exemplary laser fiber holder **980**. Laser fiber holder **980** may be a stamping of a flat metal sheet and rolled into a U-shape. The U-shaped laser fiber holder **980** may be at least partially positioned within a lumen of a delivery device (e.g., first lumen **112** of medical device **100**). The U-shape may be spring-loaded to anchor within the lumen of the delivery device. Bi-directional ramp **952**, lumen **981**, and/or laser fiber holder **980** of FIGS. 9A and 9B may have any of the features of ramp **752**, lumen **781**, and/or laser fiber holder **780** of FIGS. 7A and 7B, respectively.

(61) FIGS. 10A and 10B illustrate an exemplary perspective view and exemplary cross-section of an alternative exemplary laser fiber holder **1080**. Laser fiber holder **1080** may be a stamping of a flat metal sheet and rolled into a U-shape. The U-shaped laser fiber holder **1080** may be at least partially positioned within a lumen of a delivery device (e.g., first lumen **112** of medical device **100**). The U-shape may be spring-loaded to anchor within the lumen of the delivery device. Bi-directional ramps **1052**, **1054**, and **1056**, lumen **1081**, and/or laser fiber holder **1080** of FIGS. 10A and 10B may have any of the features of ramps **852**, **854**, and **856**, lumen **881**, and/or laser fiber holder **880** of FIGS. 8A and 8B.

(62) FIG. 11 illustrates an exemplary side view of an alternative exemplary laser fiber holder **1180**. Laser fiber holder **1180** is a coupler that is used to removably attach and/or couple first lumen **1183** to a distal end of lumen of a delivery device. The distal end of lumen **1183** is coupled to ramp **1152**. Ramp **1152** may bias a tool such as a laser fiber against wall **1186** of second lumen **1181**. Ramp **1152** may stabilize the laser fiber and allow fluid to pass. Laser fiber holder **1180** may additionally or alternatively be used as a suction chamber to hold kidney stones with suction while the tool is used to fragment the stone. Laser fiber holder **1180** may be disposed of after a single patient use.

(63) FIG. 12-14 illustrate helix laser fiber holders. In some examples, these exemplary helixes may

extend the entire length of the laser fiber **120**. In other examples, the exemplary helixes may be offset from the tip, e.g., approximately 50 mm from the distal tip. Each helix may attach to the laser fiber or the interior surface of a lumen of a delivery device. The height of each helix in combination with the diameter of the laser fiber may be approximately the same as the inner diameter of the lumen of the delivery device. This may stabilize the laser fiber, and yet fluid may flow through the open spaces between pitches of each helix. Each of the below described helixes may be flexible enough to pass or be deflected within the lumen of the device.

(64) FIG. **12** illustrates an exemplary side view of an alternative exemplary laser fiber holder **1281** wrapped around ball tip laser fiber **120**. Laser fiber holder **1281** is a double helix coil. The helix **1281** protrudes from the surface of the laser fiber **120**. The double helix is used to stabilize the laser fiber within a lumen of a delivery device and yet allow fluids to pass between each helix.

(65) FIG. **13** illustrates an exemplary side view of an alternative exemplary laser fiber holder and a laser fiber. In this example, only one helix is used as laser fiber holder **1381**. In some examples, a single helix laser fiber holder may have a tighter pitch than a double helix laser fiber holder.

(66) FIG. **14** illustrates an exemplary side view of an alternative exemplary laser fiber holder **1481** and a laser fiber **120**. The helical pattern may include intermittent gaps **1360** to assist with flow. At these gaps the height of the helix may be smaller than at other locations along the helix to allow fluid to pass through.

(67) The many features of the disclosure are apparent from the detailed specification, and thus, it is intended by the appended claims to cover all such features of the disclosure which fall within the true spirit and scope of the disclosure. Further, since numerous modifications and variations will readily occur to those skilled in the art, it is not desired to limit the disclosure to the exact construction and operation illustrated and described, and accordingly, all suitable modifications and equivalents may be resorted to, falling within the scope of the disclosure.

(68) Other aspects of the disclosure will be apparent to those skilled in the art from consideration of the specification and practice of the invention disclosed herein. It is intended that the specification and examples be considered as exemplary only, with a true scope and spirit of the invention being indicated by the following claims.

Claims

1. A laser fiber holder, comprising: a conduit having a first proximal hole and a second distal hole opposite the first hole, the conduit configured to stabilize a laser fiber extending through the first hole and the second hole; a proximal portion extending circumferentially around the conduit and forming the first proximal hole, wherein a proximalmost end of the proximal portion is configured to be removably coupled to a distalmost end of a lumen of a delivery device, wherein the delivery device is configured to receive the laser fiber; and a distal portion extending circumferentially around the conduit and forming the second distal hole, wherein a first width of the distal portion is less than a second width of the proximal portion, and wherein a first height of the distal portion is less than a second height of the proximal portion.

2. The laser fiber holder of claim 1, wherein the conduit is coupleable via the first hole to a distal opening of the lumen of the delivery device configured to receive the laser fiber.

3. The laser fiber holder of claim 2, wherein the laser fiber is stabilized relative to one or more of the lumen and an imaging device of the delivery device.

4. The laser fiber holder of claim 1, wherein the conduit has a third hole on a radial surface of the conduit.

5. The laser fiber holder of claim 4, wherein the lumen of the delivery device is configured to supply fluid and receive the laser fiber, and the third hole is configured to allow the fluid supplied from the lumen to flow through the laser fiber holder.

6. The laser fiber holder of claim 4, wherein the lumen of the delivery device is configured to apply

suction and receive the laser fiber, and the third hole is configured to allow the suction from the lumen to be applied through the laser fiber holder.

7. The laser fiber holder of claim 1, wherein the laser fiber holder has an inverted configuration and an extended configuration.

8. The laser fiber holder of claim 7, wherein, in the inverted configuration, the laser fiber holder is coupled to and disposed within the lumen of the delivery device configured to receive the laser fiber as a distal portion of the delivery device is inserted into a body.

9. The laser fiber holder of claim 8, wherein the laser fiber holder transitions from the inverted configuration to the extended configuration as the laser fiber is received by the lumen of the delivery device and extended through the first hole and the second hole of the conduit.

10. A laser fiber holder, comprising: a conduit having a first proximal hole, a second distal hole opposite the first hole, and a third hole on a radial surface of the laser fiber holder; a proximal portion extending circumferentially around the conduit and forming the first proximal hole, wherein a proximalmost end of the proximal portion is configured to be removably coupled to a distalmost end of a lumen of a delivery device, wherein the delivery device is configured to receive the laser fiber; and a distal portion extending circumferentially around the conduit and forming the second distal hole; wherein the conduit is configured to stabilize a laser fiber disposed in the lumen and extended from the distalmost end of the lumen through the first hole and the second hole; and wherein the conduit is configured to allow fluid flow or suction application from the lumen through the laser fiber holder via the third hole.

11. The laser fiber holder of claim 10, wherein the conduit has one or more additional holes each on a different radial surface of the conduit than the third hole.

12. The laser fiber holder of claim 10, wherein the third hole is located on a first radial surface of the conduit, and the laser fiber holder further comprises a fourth hole on a second radial surface of the conduit opposite the first radial surface.

13. The laser fiber holder of claim 10, wherein the laser fiber holder has an inverted configuration and an extended configuration relative to the lumen.

14. The laser fiber holder of claim 10, wherein the laser fiber is stabilized relative to one or more of the lumen and an imaging device of the delivery device.

15. A delivery device, comprising: a lumen configured to deliver a laser fiber received by the lumen into a body through a distal opening of the lumen; and a laser fiber holder removably coupled to the distal opening of the lumen, the laser fiber holder comprising a conduit having a first proximal hole and a second distal hole opposite the first proximal hole, wherein a first portion the laser fiber holder is at a proximalmost end of the laser fiber holder and is coupled to the distal opening of the lumen via the first proximal hole and a second portion of the laser fiber holder is at a distalmost end of the laser fiber holder and is positioned distal from the distal opening of the lumen, and wherein the laser fiber is extendable through the first hole and the second hole to stabilize the laser fiber; wherein the laser fiber holder is configured to transition from (i) a first extended position in which the first portion is positioned proximal to the second portion and (ii) a second inverted position in which the first portion is positioned distal to the second portion and the laser fiber holder is positioned entirely within the lumen.

16. The delivery device of claim 15, wherein a first width of the first portion of the laser fiber holder is greater than a second width of the second portion of the laser fiber holder, and wherein a first height of the first portion of the laser fiber holder is greater than a second height of the second portion of the laser fiber holder.

17. The delivery device of claim 16, wherein the conduit is tapered such that the conduit reduces in size in the distal direction.

18. The delivery device of claim 16, wherein the laser fiber holder transitions from the second inverted position to the first extended position as the laser fiber is extended through the first hole and the second hole.

19. The delivery device of claim 15, wherein the conduit further comprises one or more additional holes on one or more radial surfaces of the conduit.
20. The delivery device of claim 15, wherein the first portion of the laser fiber holder is configured to remain in the same position in both the first extended position and the second inverted position.
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